Harry White and his team at the US Treasury had prepared a draft scheme for setting up an international institution for encouraging international investment in the post-war period. The proposal was for establishment of a Bank for Reconstruction and Development of the United and Associated Nations as a companion agency to the Stabilization Fund. This did not formally come up to the Central Board but this scheme which was announced on November 24, 1943, came to be approved (with some modifications), at the Bretton Woods Conference. White's chief interest was the Fund and the preliminary work for the Bank lagged far behind and doubts were expressed if there would be sufficient time to formulate definite proposals which would culminate in a definite agreement at the Conference. That the World Bank was also born at Bretton Woods (Master Fund and Miss Bank as Keynes famously called the Bretton Woods twins), was due largely to the skill and initiative with which Keynes hurried through proposals for the Bank much to the irritation of some of the other delegates.

The proposed Bank was to have a share capital of $10 billion, to be subscribed by members in agreed proportions, determined on the basis of the members' national income and foreign trade. Payments were to be made in gold and the local currency. The monetary unit was to be unitas the same as the Fund. The Bank was to have powers to guarantee, participate in or make loans to any member country, or through the government of such country to any business or industrial concern in that country, subject to certain conditions. The Bank could also engage in other activities with the approval of its members like buying and selling any of its securities, borrowing from member governments and central banks, and buying or selling of foreign exchange after consultation with the Stabilization Fund.

On May 26, 1944, Morgenthau issued a press release stating that President Roosevelt had called an international conference to discuss post-war international problems and for ''formulating proposals of a definite character for an international monetary fund and possibly a bank for reconstruction and development.' Invitations had been extended to all the United Nations and the nations associated with them in the war, requesting them to send official representatives to the conference to be held at Bretton Woods, New Hampshire from July 1. The invitation explicitly stated that all agreements worked out at the Conference would be subsequently submitted